Populism in North America, particularly the United States, has evolved along different lines, often reflecting a divide between “heartland” values and perceived elitism on the coasts. Populism in the United States can be traced to the Jacksonian era. Andrew Jackson’s presidency (1829–1837) was marked by opposition to elite-controlled institutions like the Second Bank of the United States and a preference for direct democratic mechanisms over intermediaries like the Electoral College. Populist appeals intensified during the mid-twentieth century, driven by anxieties over communism. Leaders like Richard Nixon leveraged the idea of a “great silent majority,” a rhetorical device later revived by Donald Trump. Third-party candidates such as George Wallace and Ross Perot also tapped into populist sentiment during this time. The 2008 financial crisis marked a turning point for modern American populism. Movements like Occupy Wall Street (from the left) and the Tea Party (from the right) emerged in response to government bailouts of major banks. This discontent culminated in the 2016 election of Donald Trump, whose populist rhetoric appealed to many Americans frustrated by globalization and elite governance.

Populism in Europe also has deep roots, with modern populist thought often linked to nineteenth-century Russia. The Narodnik movement, led by intellectuals seeking to mobilize peasants against Tsarist elites, marked an early example of anti-capitalist populism. However, disunity and the lack of grassroots support limited its success. Modern European populism has surged since the 1990s, fueled by two primary grievances: European integration and immigration. These issues have given rise to far-right populist parties like the Freedom Party of Austria, France’s National Rally, Italy’s League, and Germany’s Alternative for Germany. These parties emphasize nationalism, nativism, and anti-immigration policies, often framing welfare as a privilege for a native “in-group.” While less prominent than its far-right counterpart, left-wing populism gained traction during the eurocrisis. Parties like Syriza in Greece and Podemos in Spain emerged by criticizing austerity measures imposed by the IFIs.

However, populism’s appeal extends well beyond these traditional geographic strongholds. For example, in Australia and New Zealand, right-wing populism mirrors Western European trends, focusing on immigration and welfare concerns. In Asia, populist leaders in the region opposed globalization and the involvement of IFIs following the 1997 Asian financial